

## Erin A. York

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| CONTACT<br>INFORMATION        | Department of Political Science<br>Vanderbilt University<br>Commons Center, Nashville, TN 37212                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <i>E-mail:</i> erin.a.york@vanderbilt.edu<br><i>Website:</i> eayork.github.io |
| ACADEMIC<br>APPOINTMENTS      | <b>Vanderbilt University</b> , Nashville, TN<br>C. Family Dean's Faculty Fellow<br>Assistant Professor, Political Science<br><b>Princeton University</b> , Princeton, NJ<br>Postdoctoral Fellow, Niehaus Center for Globalization and Governance<br><b>Harvard University</b> , Cambridge, MA<br>Research Fellow, Middle East Initiative                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 2021-present<br>2020-2021<br>2019-2020                                        |
| EDUCATION                     | <b>Columbia University</b> , New York, NY<br>Ph.D., Political Science<br>• Dissertation: <i>Democratic Institutions under Autocracy</i><br>M.Phil., Political Science<br>M.A., Political Science<br><b>Yale University</b> , New Haven, CT<br>B.S., Physics<br>• <i>cum laude</i> , With Honors in the Major<br>• Second Major: Near Eastern Languages and Civilizations                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | May 2020<br>May 2016<br>February 2015<br>May 2009                             |
| PEER-REVIEWED<br>PUBLICATIONS | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>[1] with Daniel Tavana, Legislative Cooptation in Authoritarian Regimes: Policy Co-operation in the Kuwait National Assembly. <i>British Journal of Political Science</i> 55.e72 (2025). <a href="#">Link</a>.<ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Best Paper Award (runner-up), King's College QPE Research Group (2021)</li></ul></li><li>[2] Constituency Service and Electoral Accountability in Autocratic Legislatures. <i>Comparative Political Studies</i> 58.8 (2025). <a href="#">Link</a>.</li><li>[3] Ministries matter: Technocrats and regime loyalty under autocracy. <i>Political Science Research and Methods</i> 12.1 (2024): 207-219. <a href="#">Link</a>.</li><li>[4] Preferences over Foreign Migration: Testing Existing Explanations in the Gulf. <i>World Politics</i> 74.3 (2022): 443-475. <a href="#">Link</a>.</li><li>[5] with Jacob Kopas and Johannes Urpelainen, Greasing the Wheels: The Politics of Environmental Clearances in India. <i>Studies in Comparative International Development</i> 57.1 (2022): 113-144. <a href="#">Link</a>.</li><li>[6] with Tara Slough and Michael Ting, A Dynamic Model of Primaries. <i>Journal of Politics</i> 82.4 (2020): 1443-1457. <a href="#">Link</a>.</li><li>[7] with Jacob Kopas, Xiaomeng Jin, S. P. Harish, Ryan Kennedy, Shiran Victoria Shen, and Johannes Urpelainen, Environmental Justice in India: Incidence of Air Pollution from Coal-Fired Power Plants. <i>Ecological Economics</i> 176 (2020): 106711. <a href="#">Link</a>.</li><li>[8] with Daniel Corstange, Sectarian Framing in the Syrian Civil War, <i>American Journal of Political Science</i> 62.2 (2018): 441-455. <a href="#">Link</a>.</li></ul> |                                                                               |

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| BOOK CHAPTERS        | [9] with Daniel Corstange, Clientelism, Constituency Service, and Elections in <i>Oxford Handbook on Politics in Muslim Societies</i> . Oxford University Press: 2022.                      |
|                      | [10] with Donald P. Green, Field Experiments in Political Behavior, in <i>The Routledge Handbook of Elections, Voting Behavior, and Public Opinion</i> (pp. 509-521), Routledge: 2018.      |
| OTHER PUBLICATIONS   | [11] with Jeff Martini and William Young, Syria as an Arena of Strategic Competition, <i>RAND Corporation</i> (Santa Monica, CA: 2013).                                                     |
|                      | [12] with Todd Helmus and Peter Chalk, Promoting Online Voices for Countering Violent Extremism, <i>RAND Corporation</i> (Santa Monica, CA: 2013).                                          |
|                      | [13] with Jeff Martini and Dalia Dassa Kaye, Muslim Brotherhood Youth: Generational Divides and Implications for U.S. Engagement, <i>RAND Corporation</i> (Santa Monica, CA: 2012).         |
| RESEARCH IN PROGRESS | [14] with Alicia Cooperman, Alexander Hamilton, Craig Hammer, and Tara Slough. <i>Monitoring &amp; Evaluation Manual in Fragile States</i> (Book-length manuscript). <i>Under R&amp;R</i> . |
|                      | [15] with Abhit Bhandari, Political Connections, Patronage, and Consumer Attitudes. <i>Under Review</i> .                                                                                   |
|                      | [16] Political Competition in Autocratic Institutions. <i>In progress</i> .                                                                                                                 |
|                      | [17] Cosponsorship and Collective Action in an Authoritarian Legislature. <i>In progress</i> .                                                                                              |
|                      | [18] Buying Autocratic Supermajorities. <i>In progress</i> .                                                                                                                                |
|                      | [19] with Daniel Tavana, Ideological Positioning in Authoritarian Legislatures. <i>In progress</i> .                                                                                        |
|                      | [20] Elections, Legislatures, and Power-sharing in Authoritarian Regimes <i>In progress</i> .                                                                                               |
|                      | [21] with Eunji Kim, Food for Thought: When Cultural Agents Turn to Politics During Wartime. <i>In progress</i> .                                                                           |
|                      | [22] with Ben Noble, Authoritarian Legislatures (chapter in edited volume) <i>In progress</i> .                                                                                             |
|                      |                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS | EXTERNAL                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                      | Bright Data                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|                      | • Bright Initiative Grant, 2024 (\$1500)                                                                                                                                                    |
|                      | National Science Foundation                                                                                                                                                                 |
|                      | • Graduate Research Fellowship, 2014–2017 (\$138000)                                                                                                                                        |
|                      | Project on Middle East Political Science                                                                                                                                                    |
|                      | • Travel Research Engagement Grant, 2016 (\$3000)                                                                                                                                           |
|                      | U.S. Department of Education                                                                                                                                                                |
|                      | • Foreign Language and Area Studies Fellowship (Arabic), 2015 (\$7500)                                                                                                                      |
|                      | U.S. Department of State                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                      | • Fulbright Fellowship, Damascus, Syria, 2009–2010                                                                                                                                          |
|                      | • Critical Language Award (Arabic), 2009                                                                                                                                                    |
|                      | INTERNAL                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                      | Vanderbilt University                                                                                                                                                                       |
|                      | • Global Engagement Grant, 2025 (\$1,000)                                                                                                                                                   |
|                      | • Dean’s Faculty Fellowship, 2022-2024 (\$30,000)                                                                                                                                           |
|                      | • Course Improvement Grant, 2022 (\$500)                                                                                                                                                    |

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|                                          | <p>Columbia University</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Dissertation Development Fellowship, 2016, 2017 (\$5300)</li> <li>• Katerina Alevizaki Dracopoulos Summer Fellowship, 2016, 2017 (\$6750)</li> <li>• Middle East Institute Research Fellowship, 2014 (\$750)</li> <li>• Graduate Fellowship, Institute for Comparative Literature and Society, 2013 - 2016</li> <li>• Dean's Fellowship, 2013</li> </ul> <p>Yale University</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Bensinger Prize, 2009 (\$3000)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE                  | <p><b>USAID Democracy, Human Rights, and Governance</b><br/>Contracted by NORC<br/><i>Impact Evaluation Specialist</i> February 2015 to June 2019</p> <p><b>World Bank</b><br/><i>Consultant</i> August 2016 to December 2017</p> <p><b>RAND Corporation</b>, Washington, DC<br/><i>Adjunct Researcher</i> August 2013 to June 2015<br/><i>Research Associate</i> June 2011 to August 2013</p> <p><b>Project on Middle East Democracy</b>, Washington, DC<br/><i>Research Assistant</i> January to June 2011</p> <p><b>Arabic and Middle Eastern Electronic Library</b>, Yale University<br/><i>Digitization Specialist</i> May 2006 to May 2009</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION & INVITED TALKS | <p>2025: SPSA; University of Rochester Wallis Institute of Political Economy; Project on Middle East Political Science (POMEPS) virtual workshop; EPSA; APSA</p> <p>2024: SPSA; EPSA; APSA; Women in Legislative Studies conference</p> <p>2023: SPSA; Copenhagen Business School "Money in Politics" conference; EPSA; APSA; Women in Legislative Studies conference</p> <p>2022: European Political Science Association annual meeting; International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP) annual meeting, APSA</p> <p>2021: Princeton University Workshop on Arab Political Development; Association for Analytic Learning about Islam and Muslim Societies (AALIMS); Princeton University IR Colloquium; SPSA; APSA; Middle East Studies Association (MESA) annual meeting</p> <p>2020: Harvard Kennedy School; Virtual Workshop on Authoritarian Regimes (VWAR); Project on Middle East Political Science (POMEPS) virtual workshop; SPSA</p> <p>2019: Vanderbilt University; APSA</p> <p>2017: Formal Theory and Comparative Politics Conference (Emory); Project on Middle East Political Science (POMEPS) annual conference; Winter Experimental Social Sciences Institute (NYU Abu Dhabi); APSA</p> <p>2016: AUB-Bobst-Princeton "After the Uprisings" (Princeton); MPSA; APSA</p> |
| TEACHING                                 | <p><b>Vanderbilt University</b>, undergraduate</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• The Politics of Autocracy</li> <li>• Understanding Policy Data</li> <li>• Political Science Honors Seminar (Thesis capstone course)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

**Vanderbilt University**, graduate

- Comparative Authoritarianism

**Columbia University**, graduate

- Math review course for incoming students, 2018 and 2019

PROFESSIONAL  
SERVICE

Chair, Best Dissertation Award Committee, APSA Democracy & Autocracy (2025)

Coordinator, Vanderbilt University Comparative Politics Workshop (2023-2024)

Coordinator, Columbia University Political Science Methods Workshop (2014-2016)

Referee, *American Political Science Review*, *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, *Democratization*, *Studies in Comparative International Development*, *Comparative Politics*, *World Politics*, *American Journal of Political Science*, *British Journal of Middle Eastern Studies*, *Journal of Information Technology and Politics*, *Political Behavior*, *Comparative Political Studies*

EXPERTISE

**Languages:** Arabic (advanced) - MSA and Levantine Colloquial

French (advanced)

Spanish (intermediate)

Farsi (beginning-intermediate)

**Computing:** R, Stata, Selenium, JMP, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, ArcGIS